



TRACKING methane from reservoirs such as Shasta Lake could help in making decisions about hydropower. MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times

Under water, a hidden methane source

Decaying plants create greenhouse gas. State is urged to track reservoirs' emissions.

By IAN JAMES

Methane, the second-biggest contributor to climate change, is spewing into the atmosphere from the oil and gas industry, landfills and dairy farms. It's also coming from another lesser-known source: reservoirs.

As plants break down underwater, they form methane, which then bubbles to the surface. California doesn't monitor how much is coming from these waters, but now several environmental groups are urging air regulators to find out, and some experts agree it's important.

"Reservoirs constitute an important source of methane," said John Harrison, a professor at Washington State University's School of the Environment who studies the greenhouse gases that reservoirs emit.

Tracking it, he said, would help California make better decisions about hydropower as part of its energy mix and "enhance the state's status as a climate policy leader."

The coalition of environmental groups — including Friends of the River, Tell the Dam Truth and five other organizations, as well as the clothing company Patagonia — submitted a petition last month saying the California Air Resources Board should require reports on greenhouse gases from dams and reservoirs. They oppose dams because they harm rivers.

The board is in charge of regulating pollutants that cause global warming. California

[See Climate, A6]

L.A., Olympic boss face off over contracts

City officials want a big share of Games business

By James Rainey

With the 2028 Olympics approaching, Los Angeles city officials are pushing hard to make sure local and small businesses within the city get a big share of the massive contracts generated by the Games.

But Olympic officials say they worry that limiting the contracts to firms within the city limits could hurt competition and end up making the Games more expensive.

The friction between the two sides erupted in public Tuesday when L.A. City Council committee members interrogated LA28 Chief Executive Reynold Hoover about "procurement" plans for the monthlong Olympics and Paralympics.

The chief executive of the host committee says he'll do his darnedest to make sure L.A. businesses get their fair share of the contracts, but not if it means driving up costs so much that the Games bust their \$7.1-billion budget, leaving L.A. tax-

payers on the hook for cost overruns.

At stake is an estimated \$4 billion in contracts, with roughly \$1 billion expected to go to small businesses. Local companies will provide food at Olympic venues, install fences and portable toilets, and build an equestrian cross-country course, among many other projects.

LA28's plans call for 75% of that work to be done by local companies, which the nonprofit organization defines as those based anywhere in Los Angeles, Ventura, Orange, Riverside and San Bernardino counties.

But council members told Hoover they believed his organization should be doing more to prioritize businesses within the city of Los Angeles, considering L.A. will be the epicenter of the Games and the government is taking the greatest financial risk if the Games don't make money.

If the event costs more than it brings in, L.A. will be

[See LA28, A11]

Live Nation loses at trial

New York jury finds company and Ticketmaster operated monopoly. A breakup could be a remedy.

By CERYs DAVIES AND ITZEL LUNA



MICHAEL RAPINO, president and CEO of Live Nation, leaves federal court in New York last month. MICHAEL NAGLE Bloomberg

Beverly Hills-based Live Nation and its Ticketmaster subsidiary faced a bruising courtroom loss Wednesday after a federal jury found that the company operated a monopoly over concert venues.

The verdict by a Manhattan, N.Y., jury came after a five-week trial and caps a closely watched case that could have far-reaching effects across the music industry, potentially leading to the breakup of the companies.

Ticketmaster is the world's largest ticket seller for live events, while Live Nation is a dominant force in the concert business.

The civil case began when the federal government alleged that Live Nation used its clout to engage in a variety of anti-competitive practices, including preventing venues from using multiple ticket sellers.

"It is time to hold them accountable," Jeffrey

[See Live Nation, A11]

Dodgers top Lakers in popularity contest

In an LMU survey, L.A. County residents identify their favorite local pro sports team.

By BILL SHAIKIN

The Dodgers are too good, and too rich. If the owners of other major league teams ultimately deem that combination so objectionable that they shut down the sport this winter because of it, they will risk a rupture in one of the greatest fan bases in American

sports history.

The 4 million tickets the Dodgers sold last season tells one part of the story. Here is an arguably better one: For decades, the Dodgers and Lakers have dominated Los Angeles sports and left every other team far behind in popularity.

For now, after back-to-back World Series championships, the Dodgers have left even the Lakers far behind in popularity, and every other team in town even further behind.

In a Loyola Marymount survey asking Los Angeles County residents to identify

their favorite among the 12 pro sports teams within the local media market, nearly half picked the Dodgers.

The Dodgers' lead over the Lakers — 43% to 28% — represented the largest gap between the teams in the nine editions of the survey, first conducted in 2014 by the Thomas and Dorothy Leavey Center for the Study of Los Angeles.

The Rams ranked third, at 7%, followed by the Kings at 5% and the Angels at 4%.

The two women's teams — Angel City FC and the Sparks — tied for last, each with less than 1% of the vote.

Even when the study separated votes by gender, the two women's teams each got less than 1% of the vote from women.

As recently as 2018, five teams beyond the Dodgers and Lakers — the Angels, Clippers, Galaxy, Kings and Rams — attracted at least 4% of the vote. In this year's survey, only the Rams and Kings did.

"I'm a big Rams fan," said Fernando Guerra, the center's director, "and I still put the Dodgers first."

"I love all these teams. But, when you have to

[See Popularity, A7]

Trump weighs talks with Iran amid troop surge

U.S. will have 60,000 deployed in the region, with ceasefire expiring next week.

By MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — With a fragile ceasefire set to expire with Iran in a matter of days, President Trump is still deciding between diplomacy and a resumption of fighting that may ultimately hinge on his definition of victory.

Negotiations have continued over the last week between the warring sides over a potential agreement that would end the conflict and curtail Iran's nuclear ambitions, with interlocutors from Pakistan passing messages that have kept talks alive. Tehran has floated an extension of the two-week ceasefire, set to expire Tuesday, that is under active consideration by the American side.

But the Islamic Republic has simultaneously vowed retaliation over a new U.S. blockade of Iranian ports that in effect cut off Tehran's oil sales, which make up

nearly 85% of the country's export revenue. And the Trump administration is deploying up to 10,000 additional troops to the region, on top of the 50,000 already there, both reinforcing the blockade and threatening ground operations if diplomacy fails.

Conflicting messages from the Trump administration are designed to escalate pressure on Tehran ahead of the ceasefire deadline, potentially extracting concessions at the negotiating table.

But speaking with reporters, Trump has made it clear he is seeking a way to end the war for good.

"I think it's close to over," Trump told Fox Business Network's "Mornings with Maria" on Wednesday. "I view it as very close to over. If I pulled up stakes right now, it would take them 20 years to rebuild that country. And we're not finished. We'll see what happens. I think they want to make a deal very badly."

Negotiations toward that end have proved more challenging than the administration initially anticipated.

Trump has said he

[See Iran, A6]



FATEMEH BAHRAMI Anadolu

A BANNER seen in Tehran on Wednesday depicts Iranian military leaders and the Strait of Hormuz.

War further chills L.A. home market

Buying is 'contingent on whether the Strait of Hormuz is open,' one woman jokes.

By JACK FLEMMING

Katie Davis has whiplash.

A longtime renter, she's in the market for her first home, but she needs mortgage rates to drop in order to afford the monthly payments. Anything under 6% would be feasible.

For the last year, she's been tracking them like a hawk. She watched them drop from 7% last spring to 6.5% in the fall until they finally dipped below 6% in February.

"I thought my time had finally come," Davis said.

Days later, a series of airstrikes kicked off the Iran war, sending mortgage rates up. Then, this month, the U.S. struck a ceasefire deal, bringing rates back down again. During that stretch, Davis has waffled between hopeless and hopeful on a weekly basis.

"I just want a little starter house in El Sereno, but

somehow it feels contingent on whether the Strait of Hormuz is open or not," she said.

A small swing in mortgage rates might not feel like much, but for many first-time homebuyers, the margins of affordability are razor-thin in Southern California's expensive market, and \$200 more for a monthly payment can be the difference between keeping up with a loan or being crushed by it.

Los Angeles' housing market was already cold; according to Zillow, only 3,072 homes traded hands in L.A. County in January, the lowest monthly total in three years. The Iran war all but froze it, sending mortgage rates back up to 6.46% and pulling would-be buyers out of the market.

In February, the median L.A. home for sale spent 80 days on the market — the longest median in the last five years, according to Redfin. In addition, 17.6% of home listings had price cuts, up 1.4 percentage points year over year.

There's a growing chasm between the number of sellers and buyers in the market in L.A., mirroring a national

[See Real estate, A6]

L.A. may ban e-bikes on most trails

Concerns over safety prompt a City Council panel to advance proposal to a committee. CALIFORNIA, B1

State Bar flags lawyers' AI use

Three attorneys face discipline over false legal citations in court filings. CALIFORNIA, B1

Weather

Partly sunny. L.A. Basin: 74/56. B6

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Snap is latest to announce layoffs

Snapchat parent cuts 1,000 workers in an effort to reduce costs and boost AI. BUSINESS, A9

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